Data Center and Virtualization Experience

(Foundation for Cloud and Enterprise Architecture)

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Operational foundation and relevance to target roles

My cloud architecture and security leadership is built on decades of real data center and virtualization accountability since the 1990s, including operations, platform reliability, backup and DR, monitoring, and hybrid infrastructure realities, plus running data center responsibilities remotely (RNL). I have a legacy of modernization to hybrid environments, and into cloud, including designing and managing infrastructure built for AI services, remotely (RNL). The result is architecture, governance, and delivery that survives contact with production because it is grounded in how systems actually fail, recover, and operate; because I understand the constraints, failure modes, and operational mechanics end to end.

- **Principal / Enterprise Architect**: Architecture that is operable. I build reference architectures and platform decisions that account for identity, network, compute, storage, virtualization layers, observability, DR, and run-state reality.
- **Director, GRC and Cybersecurity**: Controls that are enforceable. I translate requirements into technical controls across IAM, segmentation, endpoint posture, virtualization hardening, backup immutability, monitoring, evidence capture, and DR testing.
- **Technical Program Director**: Modernization that lands safely. I lead sequencing and cutovers, risk and dependency management, operational readiness, and post-cutover stabilization for infrastructure and platform transformations.

Core Data Center and Virtualization Competencies

- Data center operations: production support, change control, outage management, root cause analysis, capacity planning, and service continuity
- Virtualization platforms: VMware ESX/ESXi and vCenter operations, P2V migrations, environment standardization (dev/test/prod)
- Hybrid patterns: on-prem + hosted + cloud integrations, network segmentation, identity integration, and secure connectivity
- Backup, DR, and recoverability: backup platforms, log shipping patterns, cutover planning, and validation of recovery objectives
- Security foundations: firewall/routing rules, VPN connectivity, Active Directory / identity, and secure administrative access patterns

Experience timeline (data center and virtualization)

Ruffalo Noel Levitz (RNL) | Enterprise Architect / Acting CISO | Remote, 2023–2025

- Managed and governed a hybrid environment spanning AWS, Azure, IBM Cloud, and on-prem components, with architecture models for segmentation and isolation of sensitive environments (including CHD/PII scope).
- Drove operational maturity through runbooks, diagrams, evidence cycles, and operational governance that ties infrastructure controls to audit requirements.
- Operated as a hands-on technical leader across identity, network boundaries, endpoint controls, backups, and platform monitoring to support continuity and compliance.

Note: This was largely remote leadership and execution, including responsibility for platform reliability and recoverability in production environments.

South Jersey Industries (SJI) | Infrastructure & Security Manager | 2022–2023

- Managed private hybrid cloud across two data centers supporting IT/Corporate and OT/SCADA environments, with multiple vCenter environments and large-scale server footprint.

- Owned incident response and RCA for Sev1 outages across compute, network, storage, and telecom; improved monitoring and operational responsiveness using SolarWinds and ServiceNow.
- Designed shared services patterns leveraging Azure and M365 integrations to reduce data center footprint while improving identity, patching, security tooling, and remote site consistency.

Note: Due to critical infrastructure sensitivity, examples are described at a high level; detailed artifacts can be shared in a sanitized form when appropriate.

Talkiatry | VP Infrastructure | 2020–2021

- Inherited a mixed environment and executed modernization toward a cloud-first model, leveraging prior data center and virtualization discipline for change control, standardization, and operational readiness.
- Implemented identity-centric access patterns (SSO/SAML, MFA), endpoint management, and secure admin workflows that mirror mature data center operations in a cloud context.

City of Philadelphia (DPH / Prison System) | Infrastructure Architect | 2012–2020

- Supported hybrid environments where local data center assets and virtual servers integrated with SaaS partners; maintained on-prem database copies via log shipping for reporting and integration use cases.
- Operated and supported physical and virtual server infrastructure supporting EHR, lab systems, and integration engines, including VPN connectivity and secured partner interfaces.
- Global administrator responsibilities for modern office migration and identity federation, while maintaining reliability of local data center dependencies.

FirstLab / Genomind | CIO | 2011–2012

- Stabilized and upgraded a risky local data center footprint by hardening facilities and migrating to a hybrid virtualized environment.
- Virtualized servers (P2V) into VMware ESXi, standardizing environments and improving recoverability.
- Upgraded production infrastructure and databases with improved redundancy and backup patterns to support regulated operations.

Canon Technology Solutions | Lead Architect | 2006–2009

- Built and operated VMware-based demo and proof-of-concept environments using ESX/ESXi and vSphere upgrades, supporting multiple enterprise workloads and client demonstrations.
- Led large-scale data center move planning and execution for a major client, coordinating racks, cabling, cutover sequencing, and a hard deadline return-to-service window.

Computer Sciences Corporation (CSC) | Senior Technical Architect | 1994–2001 (notably 1999)

- Supported physical server environments in multi-tier architectures (web/app/database) across production, test, and development.
- Owned infrastructure security and connectivity elements including firewall/routing rules, VPN connectivity, and Active Directory profile integration for hosted systems.
- Operated within enterprise data center practices supporting back-end integrations to core systems (SAP).

Operating model and outputs

I'm a cloud-era enterprise architect who learned reliability in real data centers and carried that discipline into hybrid platforms, audit-ready operations, and modern cloud governance. I align architecture, operations, and controls through decision-ready artifacts that accelerate execution and reduce surprises in production.

- Decision-ready architecture: diagrams and models that make boundaries explicit (segmentation, network trust zones, identity and data flows) and map controls to the architecture.
- Operational governance: practical runbooks and operating cadence for change control, incident patterns, evidence collection, and DR validation.
- Modernization execution: migration and cutover playbooks for virtualization moves, hybrid integrations, and cloud transitions with risk gates and rollback paths.